

```
$ ./bin/run_tui.sh <command> <options>
```

Here are the few basic commands you'll need to create backups of your data and recover it using the console. All you need to have as a prerequisite is the *areca config.xml* file, which you must generate from the GUI; else, <http://areca-backup.org/config.php> is good to follow.

1. You may get the textual description of a target group by using the *describe* command as shown below:

```
$ ./bin/run_tui.sh describe -config <your xml config file>
```

2. You may launch a backup on a target or a group of targets using the *backup* command as follows:

```
$ ./bin/run_tui.sh backup -config <your xml config file>
[-target <target>] [-f] [-d] [-c] [-s] [-title <archive title>]
```

- Here, *[-f]*, *[-d]*, *[-c]*, *[-s]* are used in the case of a full backup, differential backup, for checking archive consistency after backup and for target groups, respectively.
3. If you have a backup, recover your data easily using *recover* as follows:

```
$ ./bin/run_tui.sh recover -config <config file> -target
<target> -destination <destination folder> -date <recovery
date: YYYY-MM-DD> [-c]
```

Here *[-c]* is to check and verify the recovered data.

You can learn more about command line usage at <http://areca-backup.org/documentation.php>.

Final verdict

The Areca Backup tool is one of the best personal file backup tools when you look for options in open source. Despite having a few limitations such as no support for VSS (Volume Shadow Copy Service) and its inability to create backups for files locked by other programs, Areca serves users well due to its wide variety of features. Moreover, it has a separate database of plugins which may be used to overcome almost all of its limitations. If you are looking for a personal file backup utility, go for nothing but Areca. **END** 

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The author is a FOSS lover and enjoys working on all types of FOSS projects. He is currently doing research on cloud computing and recent trends in programming. He is the founder of the project 'Brick the Code', which is meant to teach programming to kids in an easy and interactive way. If you are facing any issues with FOSS, you can contact him at yatharth@brickthecode.org

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